Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: May 24, 2023, 6:30-8:30 pm (in-person)

"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools.
They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.
Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."

Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome & Introduction** - Attendees - Approval of April Meeting Minutes	5 mins	Chair (Ling Tam)
2	**Word Matter Workshop – Microaggression Debrief** - Introductions - PPT shared with Council but will not be attached. See Principal/VP for more information. Additional resources can be made available upon request. - 5 students, parents/caregivers, & teachers - Funding for shirts provided by Council - Workshop delivered in 2 sessions: - Session 1: What is a Microaggression? Seemingly minor comment that quite insulting and discriminatory. Subtle act of discrimination. Causes inconsistent living routines, not able to do activities they used to, affects mental health - Session 2 Calling In & Calling Out. Role playing - Survey of people before presentation- 50% of people were at a level 1 or 2 (out of 5), after the workshop they were a lot more confident in identifying what a microaggression was and how to call in or call out. - Examples given that even adults have experienced this too - Participation by attendees for life examples of microaggression.	40 mins	Vice-Principal (Tara Goudy), Student & Parent Delegation
3	**News** Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com Jun 10 Neighbourhood Day Summer Camp registration	5 mins	Community Rep
	WRAPSC & PIC - See attached notes	5 mins	Assembly Rep (Amy Pharoah)

	- Revisit Council Handbook for roles & responsibilities, how to hold a meeting, etc. (see link in header)		
4	**Principal's Report** - Staffing underway for 2023-2024 year; currently status quo - Potential retirements will be announced but no specific celebrations planned. - EQAO (Gr3 & 6) to be issued next week; Administered online is less stress for teachers & students alike. Similar user interface as Google platform making it more user friendly. Reminder to parents & Council that results from this testing use for different purposes as a tool for development of more resourcing & programs for students. Assessment of a cohort not a full school. It's not Silverheight's data it's a cohort of children in grade 6 and 3. Advantage is that next year in grade 4 and 7 we can identify gaps and isolate where we should dedicate resources to support kids who may have been unsuccessful and can look at trends. Reality is meeting needs of the children in front of them today. It's so detailed you can get an idea where the gaps are for each student, only the school sees the individual child's results. - Return of assemblies & group activities in 2023-2024 year - Structure reading program purchases funded by Council complete (online & hardcopy resources; Home Reading program & Sillisense) - Gr8 trip funding approved by Council; going to Niagara Falls (Bird Kingdom, Clifton Hill). Amount of teaching and instructional time, cross curricular connections they were able to facilitate. Majority of time they do not require caregiver volunteers. Some of the top 5 requirements is a level of independence. Very structured, there is an itinerary, 2 teachers supervising at each point of entry at each time and blocking off chunks of Clifton hill at a time and can go with their fun pass. - Library renovation to "Learning Commons" - June 6 trades arrive. How will this affect the kids? Starting construction early, book collection has happened already. September 8th when we need to access resources. Front school access will not be affected. When school is over they will expand the fenced area. Increase book circulation by over 20%, don't currently meet provincial mandate for books per student and after renovation will exceed the minimum. - 2022-2023 Teacher Wish List Council-approved purchases still underway. Some items on backlog, ordered & awaiting arrival. Spent over $10,000 to support Kindergarten, Gr1/2 to shrink some gaps created through covid to utilize new literacy research that's out. New Haggerty resource if you'd like to reach that. UFLI. Supplementary reading resource for children Syllasense. Similar to the graduated reading and level reading, but not actually the same. It's more of a conceptual both from phonics and phenic perspective, if	10 mins	Principal (Jason Stere)

	you want to explore the science of reading you can look into this. Contemporary research that involves the brain, board is going towards this and it's a 3-5 year plan.		
5	**Teachers Report** - Outdoor learning as weather improves & cooperates - ACE class coffee cart, movies, community events - Therapy dogs Gr3 in the school - Swim to Survive by Gr3 at WG Johnson Centre. Gr7 asked but no participants (free busing & participation; sponsored by the City of Cambridge via grant) - May 24 Int Track & Field Day @ Jacob Hespeler HS - May 25 Class Photos - May 29 Jr Track & Field Day - May 30 Gr5 trip to Long Care Home to meet PenPals - Gr 7 Immunizations completed - Jun 2 PD Day - Jun 15 Welcome to Kindie Night - Jun 27 Gr8 Celebration - TBD - Primary Play Day. Not all class field trips listed here but several trips planned. - June is a busy month keeping students engaged & active is important. b	10 mins	Rep (Chad Moffat)
6	**Financial Report** May Run date Balance = $18,923 - Approved spend in May included funding Gr8 trip ($6K) & Syllasense reading program ($5.6K) - Teacher Wish List spend still going. Funds already allocated. Grants: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/4690-School-Generated-Funds.pdf PIC Grant – $500 received & allocated to Words Matter workshop Parents Reaching Out (PRO) Grant: $500 received & allocated to Words Matter workshop.	10 min	Treasurer
7	**Council Subcommittees** Pizza Committee Debrief	15 mins	Subcommittee Rep (Alison, Heather, Kate, and Amy)

Pizza Week #¤	Week¤	Pizza Slice Totals¤
1¤	Jan. 24¤	635 slices¤
2¤	Feb. 7¤	647 slices¤
3¤	Feb. 14¤	736 slices¤
4¤	Feb. 21¤	785 slices¤
5¤	Feb. 28¤	792 slices¤
6¤	Mar. 7¤	748 slices¤
7¤	Mar. 21¤	812 slices¤
8¤	Mar. 28¤	790 slices¤
9¤	Apr. 4¤	643 slices¤
10¤	Apr. 11¤	803 slices¤
11¤	Apr. 18¤	812 slices¤
12¤	Apr. 25¤	894 slices¤
13¤	May 2¤	785 slices¤
14¤	May 9¤	835 slices¤
15¤	May 16¤	796 slices¤
16¤	May 23¤	782 slices¤

- Tota # slices to date = 12,295 (average 768 slices/wk)
- Amount of profit = $12,295
- 3 events remaining, ending Jun 13.
- All Council fundraising from pizza days
- Historical fundraising campaigns included. Rain barrels, chocolate bars, plantables. Pizza had to pause during covid and has now resumed during Winter this year, it is quite profitable.
- ‘Give a slice’ has been a huge benefit to our community, slices have been given every week. There is $800 from this year that was given that can be allocated towards pizza for next year. Opportunity for people to give. Really grateful for how much people is given. June 13th is last pizza day.
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- Pizza- can leave frozen for Nutrition for learning program.
- New volunteers
  - Give-a-slice program: $800 from this year will be moved to next year. Maybe we can cut off mid-year for next year.
  - Last Day: Jun 13
  - Leftover pizza gets bagged, frozen, & put into the Nutrition for Learning program.

	- Pizza box recycling Fundraising Committee - Smencil sales – leftover supply in the school **Special Event initiatives** - Kindie Welcome Event (Volunteers: Michelle, Leah, Amy). Order banner (M&T board-approved vender). Students to make slideshow to showcase Council initiatives. Silverhawks school council banner to be printed as stand up sign. Can also have it on two poles extend it and no one has trouble to find it. Project to show what school council has helped to fund. Print out into kindie bags about school council. Use remaining stock of smencils/Smens/Scratch and sniff gel crayons as giveaway accompanying school council handout sheet with info on school council. - Family movie nights - DEFERRED - Community Activity Fair - DEFERRED General inbox has been receiving emails from various community extra curricular activities. Consider restarting plans to host a community activity far?		
8	**Calendar of Planned School Events** Jun 15 Welcome to Kindie Night Jun 27 Gr8 Celebration September 20 Meet the Teacher Food Truck Night	5 min	Council Members
9	**Equity Connections** - Book Club Follow-up: 4 session with 7-9 participants; Councial purchased 7 copies of the book. - Book Club 2.0 next year so current participants will be facilitators & open participation to students, parents & community connections. - May ask Council to supplement funding additional copies of book ($20/copy *30).	5 min	Council Members
10	Questions & Answer Period	5 mins	Council Members
11	Next Meeting Date: September 13 or 27 (to be determined based on School staff meeting)		In-person & online meet
12	Adjournment for School Year		

Notes:
MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education
PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)
PRO – Parents Reaching Out
SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)
WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

WRAPSC May 2023

Direction feedback/changes:

- Want more discussions on reading, learning
- Speakers about vaping and drugs
- Love the school council surveys

Right to Read: https://www.ohrc.on.ca/en/right-to-read-inquiry-report

- "The Right to Read inquiry, which focused on early reading skills, found that Ontario's public education system is failing students with reading disabilities (such as dyslexia) and many others, by not using evidence-based approaches to teach them to read." (Ontario Human Rights Commission Right to Read inquiry report)
- "Students who don't develop good early reading skills can very quickly begin to experience negative academic consequences, which may only get worse. Reading is necessary for many aspects of learning in school, and initial difficulties can increase over time and impede accessing the curriculum in other subjects. This is one of several reasons why early intervention for struggling readers is essential." (Executive Summary Right to Read Public inquiry into human rights issues affecting students with reading disabilities Ontario Human Rights Commission, page 14)
  https://www3.ohrc.on.ca/sites/default/files/Right%20to%20Read%20Executive%20Summary_OHRC%20English_0.pdf

Reading

- Child directed reading (delight directed studies) encouraged: if kids are into Pokemon, then pull out the Pokemon cards for your child to read
- Science of reading: phonics
- Home reading will stop
- Right to Read: https://www.ohrc.on.ca/en/right-to-read-inquiry-report
    - "The Right to Read inquiry, which focused on early reading skills, found that Ontario's public education system is failing students with reading disabilities (such as dyslexia) and many others, by not using evidence-based approaches to teach them to read." (Ontario Human Rights Commission Right to Read inquiry report)
    - "Students who don't develop good early reading skills can very quickly begin to experience negative academic consequences, which may only get worse. Reading is necessary for many aspects of learning in school, and initial difficulties can increase over time and impede accessing the curriculum in other subjects. This is one of several reasons why early intervention for struggling readers is essential." (Executive Summary Right to Read Public inquiry into human rights issues affecting students with reading disabilities Ontario Human Rights Commission, page 14)
      https://www3.ohrc.on.ca/sites/default/files/Right%20to%20Read%20Executive%20Summary_OHRC%20English_0.pdf
    - This inquiry changed the way educators and boards are looking at reading.
- The school board is going back to phonics because phonics (letter sounds and special sounds, for example the sound "ea" says long e, short e, or long a in leaf, thread, steak) has proven to give better results.

https://www3.ohrc.on.ca/sites/default/files/Right%20to%20Read%20Executive%20Summary_OHRC%20English_0.pdf

- "For example, in Ontario's current system, it is more likely that a student will be encouraged to predict a word from a picture in the text or guess at a word from the sentence or story context and first letter rather than being taught the sounds that letters and letter combinations represent and how to use that knowledge to "sound out" the word." (Executive Summary: Right to Read page 26)

WRAPSC https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/

- Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (WRAPSC)
- isn't a policy maker; it is more a collaboration of school councils to share ideas to improve our individual school councils
    - networking, support, and sharing of concerns, information, achievements and best practices.
    - WRAPSC meetings will resume in October. WRAPSC has no meetings historically in September, December, March, and June.
- This year though WRAPSC voiced its opinions more with the board due to PIC's tiny number of volunteers and all PIC members were inexperienced in the role
- Executive team at WRAPSC discussed WRDSB community partners list so that schools know which groups/speakers are recognized by the board.
- Chairs and/or WRAPSC representatives can continue to send questions to wrapsc@gmail.com
    - These questions are used to tailor their meetings

PIC helps advocate for parents with the school board https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/

PRO Grants:

- Past PRO grants: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/parents-reaching-out-pro-grants/
- The PRO grant committee will work with a school and share how to adapt their ideas so that it fits criteria

2 forms every school councils have to fill out at the end of every school year: "Principal Profile Form" and "Survey— End of year report"

- Principal evaluation
- School councils what we accomplished
- These forms are sent directly to the principal. The school council chair does not receive this.

1st Council Meeting of the School Year:

- 1st council meeting should be announced on School Day
- Suggestion: Cover council by-laws
    - School handbook https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf
- Elections for co-chair, secretary, WRAPSC rep, treasurer, fundraising, social media, student rep, teacher rep, other, etc.
- Vote on: in-person, virtual, or hybrid school council meetings
- Hierarchy of concerns addressed by parents: teacher, principal, superintendent, associate director, director

Best Practices:

- 91% school councils meet within the 1st 35 days of the school year.
- 74% fill election council positions in the 1st meeting within the 1st 35 days.
- How does your council communicate when the 1st council meeting will be? 79% School Day, 15% other, 3% paper handout, and 3% social media
- What roles does your council hold elections for: Co-chair 83%, Secretary 93%, Treasurer 79%, WRAPSC Rep 31%, Teacher Rep 14%, Student Rep 10%, Social Media 10%, Fundraising 17%, Other 4%
- Recap of council by-laws in the 1st meeting: 26% yes, 74% no
- Set the tone for the rest of the year at the first meeting:
    - set goals and objectives of the council, so we have a plan for our year that helps keep us focussed.
    - review major items from the past year and goals for the new year
    - How we hope to work together and that open and honest discussion with the goal of enhancing the experience for the kids as a whole. Elects other voting members. Picks day, time and frequency for meetings. Sets expectations for timing of budget.
    - explain role of council - citing the Ontario code, explain that primary function is NOT fundraising, explain how decisions are reached, explain quorum and attendance, highlight accomplishments of the previous year
    - Introductions and whose kids are in what grade
    - share an info packet ahead including roles & responsibilities (taken from the handbook) and events/fundraising some in the past, our councils purpose, etc.
    - Usually it is explained what it means to be a “member at large” (voting member) and the concept of motions and votes are explained.
    - I ask the council what they would like to see on the agenda for the year. I also tell them about all the free talks that are available for parents in the region. I give them the links and general dates and times. I give them any updates on any projects that were in the works last year, and where the project stands now, like getting a crosswalk at our school.
    - We discuss the importance of quorum. We also plan out how many meetings we will have that school year, and leave some as optional ie. March and June.
    - do a recap of activities, events and fundraising from the previous year and highlight the major year over year events already on the calendar.

School board trustees:

- Trustees present: Carla Johnson (Cambridge), Cindy Watson (Cambridge), Fred Meissner, Scott Piatkowski, Maedith Radlein, Mike Ramsay, Meena Waseem, Vice Chair Kathleen Woodcock, Chair Joanne Weston
- Associate director: Scott Miller present
- Trustees not present: Fred Meissner (sadly, recently deceased), Bill Cody (Cambridge), and Marie Snyder (recently stepped down as a trustee due to health reasons)
- Any board member can deal with your issues, but ideally you ask the one that is from your region https://www.wrdsb.ca/trustees/ Cindy Watson and Carla Johnson are from our region; they were both at the WRAPSC meeting. Bill Cody is also from Cambridge.

- Superintendents: https://www.wrdsb.ca/about-the-wrdsb/senior-team-roles-responsibilities/sawb/schools-by-area/
    - Our school's superintendent is Evelyn Giannopoulos **https://www.wrdsb.ca/about-the-wrdsb/senior-team-roles-responsibilities/sawb/#Area5**
        - Evelyn services: Cedar Creek Public School, Oak Creek Public, Centennial Public, Parkway Public, Coronation Public, Preston Public, Grand View Public, Ryerson Public, Hespeler Public, Saginaw Public, Hillcrest Public, Silverheights Public, Janet Metcalfe Public, Woodland Park Public, and Moffat Creek Public
- Trustee's job: Hires the director of our board, works to complete performance appraisals, makes decisions about policies, liaisons between parents and board, attends board meetings, serves on committees, adopts strategic plans, attends discipline hearings, and advocates for public education
- Safety changes need board approval
- Board policies: If concerned about policies or the lack of policies with the board: you can form a delegation (can be just yourself): **https://www.wrdsb.ca/trustees/become-a-delegate/**
    - You are given 10 minutes to speak
    - If you have questions regarding the delegation process, call Stephanie Reidel, Manager of Corporate Services at (519) 570-0003 x4336.
- Curriculum Concerns:
    - (Scott Miller): If you have any concerns about anything not being in the school's curriculum, then contact the Ministry of Education London West Region **https://www.southwesthealthline.ca/displayservice.aspx?id=153356**
    - Call: 519-667-1440 or TTY: 1-800-265-4221
- School policy concerns you have:
    - (Cindy Watson): If you are concerned about the schools not having a policy, include your complaint under Bill 98 **https://www.ola.org/en/legislative-business/bills/parliament-43/session-1/bill-98**
- Education act: **https://www.ontario.ca/laws/statute/90e02**
- School Council Education Act: **https://www.ontario.ca/laws/regulation/000612/v1#:~:text=(1)%20The%20purpose%20of%20school,612%2F00%2C%20s**

WRAPSC meetings will resume in October. WRAPSC has no meetings historically in September, December, March, and June.

Mental Health

WRDSB Vaping and Cannabis info for parents https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/safe-schools/cannabis-and-vaping/ , more info will be out later on this page later in the spring. They are supposed to upload the slide show that they presented at Jacob Hespeler.

WRDSB Psychology Channel https://www.youtube.com/@wrdsbpsychologydepartment/featured

WRDSB Psychology book and website recommendations:

- To read to your child:
    - Anxiety: https://www.amazon.ca/dp/B08ZD6TCZ5?ref_=cm_sw_r_cp_ud_dp_2RHMMKVVYXJ4XCEF8RHT
    - Listening to their bodies: https://www.amazon.ca/dp/099895800X?_encoding=UTF8&psc=1&ref_=cm_sw_r_cp_ud_dp_AVVP9DN0X3QNNB6ASY3Q
- Website: Advice for parents, kids, and teens: https://kidshealth.org/
- Books for parents:
    - **Raising Humans in a Digital World. Helping Kids Build a Healthy Relationship with Technology** by Diana Graber:
    - https://www.chapters.indigo.ca/en-ca/books/raising-humans-in-a-digital/9780814439791-item.html?ikwid=raising+humans+in+a+digital+world&ikwsec=Home&ikwidx=0#algoliaQueryId=cfe989ff7ef6a340ed82e74a39e5fcfa
    - **Behind their Screens What Teens are Facing (and Adults are Missing)** by Emily Weinstein and Carrie James:
    - https://www.chapters.indigo.ca/en-ca/books/behind-their-screens-what-teens/9780262047357-item.html?ikwid=behind+their+screens&ikwsec=Home&ikwidx=0#algoliaQueryId=1557002f4ab3c396576c8209af54ff4a